Shoot Brief — Game Day

Everything you need for the day, shooting solo: access, roles, gear, the run of show, the shot list, and the fallbacks. Fill the logistics table once the game is confirmed.

Logistics

Fill this once the game is confirmed. Every time in the run of show below is relative to tip-off, so the table drives the whole day.

Item	Detail
Game date	TBD
Venue	Ramat Gan, home arena
Home or away	Home
Opponent	TBD
Tip-off	TBD
Ahmad's arrival time	TBD (ask him; usually 90 to 120 minutes before tip-off)
Crew	Eran, solo: director, camera, sound, interviewer
Call time	45 minutes before Ahmad's arrival
Access	Court before the game. Gallery with the crowd from tip-off to the final buzzer. Court again after the game. No tunnel, no locker room.
Conversation location and time	TBD. Recommended: the car ride home, same night
Club contact	TBD, name and phone
Parking and load-in	TBD

Access and permissions

What we have is enough for this film: the court before and after, the gallery during. Confirm the few things below so the day has no surprises.

- [ ] Confirm with the club that one person with a camera can be on the court during warm-ups, from Ahmad's arrival until the players go in before tip-off

- [ ] Ask for a fixed standing spot in the gallery: first row, near half court, clean line to both baskets. If it is general admission, arrive early and hold it
- [ ] Confirm we can be back on the floor as soon as the final buzzer goes, for about ten minutes
- [ ] Ask whether we can stay on the court for a few minutes after the players leave, for the empty-court shots. If not, we take them during warm-ups from the far end
- [ ] A one-line message to the team group through Ahmad: a camera will be at warm-ups, nobody has to do anything
- [ ] League or broadcaster rules on using footage shot from the stands in a personal video. What we shoot ourselves is normally fine; check for watermark or credit requirements
- [ ] Music: licensed tracks only (Artlist, Epidemic, or a composer). No trending audio in the YouTube film
- [ ] Ahmad's own approval of the final cut before anything is posted
- [ ] The car: who drives, whose car, and that Ahmad is fine with a mount on the window or dash

Crew and roles

One person does everything: director, camera, sound, interviewer. That is fine for this film, and it is the reason the crew disappears, but it means one setup at a time and no second chances. The whole day is designed around that: one body, one lens change per phase, the lav on Ahmad whenever he is in street clothes, and a phone as the only second angle.

Phase	Setup in hand	What you are doing
Arrival	Body on the gimbal, 24-70 or 35mm. Lav on Ahmad, receiver on the body	Shoot the approach from far, then walk with him. One question on the walk
Warm-ups	Body off the gimbal, handheld or monopod, 24-70. Lav off before he goes to the bench	Rituals, the shooting routine from three angles one after another, stretching, the huddle, the quiet moment
Game	Body on the monopod, 70-200. Phone in pocket for vertical crowd shots	From the gallery: plays, reactions, bench, crowd, scoreboard. Come down in the final minute
After the game	Handheld, 35 or 50. Lav back on as you greet him	Twenty seconds of silence, three questions, then the empty-court shots on the tripod

Phase	Setup in hand	What you are doing
Conversation	Body on a window or dash mount, 35mm. Phone on a small mount for the second angle. Lav plus recorder	Drive or walk, talk, never stop rolling

Ahmad's side. One contact at the club who can confirm the court access in writing. If a friend or family member is at the game, they can hold the phone for the second angle during the conversation, or simply be a natural interaction in beat 1.

Gear list

Category	Item	Notes
Camera	One full-frame mirrorless body, 4K, 10-bit log	24 or 25 fps for the film; 50 or 60 fps for the game and the shooting routine
Lenses	24-70 f/2.8, 70-200 f/2.8, one 35 or 50 prime	70-200 for the game from the gallery; the prime for post-game and the car
Support	Gimbal, monopod, one light tripod, a window or dash mount for the car	Monopod in the gallery; tripod only for the empty-court shots and the car
Audio	One wireless lav with receiver on the camera, a small recorder as backup	Lav on from arrival to the bench, again from the final buzzer onward. Record room tone wherever you are
Second angle	Phone with a small clamp or mini tripod	Passenger side in the car; vertical crowd shots from the gallery
Light	One small bi-color LED, pocket size	Car only, dimmed, bounced off the ceiling or the passenger sun visor. Never in the arena
Filters	Variable ND for the 24-70	Arena light is mixed; set white balance manually during warm-ups
Media and power	Cards for 5 hours per body, 6 batteries, a charger in the car	Change the card and battery while walking up to the gallery, and again at halftime
Misc	Gaffer tape, lens cloth, water, the run of show on your phone	Keep the bag light; you carry everything up the stairs

Run of show

All times relative to tip-off (T). Replace with clock times once the logistics table is filled. One operator, so every phase names the one setup you carry and the one lens change between phases.

Time	Where	What you capture	Setup	Sound
T-3:15	Venue	Arrive, meet the club contact, confirm the court access and your gallery spot. White balance and exposure set on the court. Exterior wides of the arena in daylight. Room tone of the empty hall.	Gimbal, 24-70	Recorder, room tone
T-2:30	Parking or entrance	Ahmad arrives. The approach from far, then walk with him. Details on the move. The one question. His first look at the court from the entrance.	Gimbal, 24-70, then 35mm	Lav on in the parking lot
T-2:00	Court	His rituals. Stepping onto the floor. Stretching. The shooting routine, three angles one after the other. Teammates and the huddle from the far side.	Handheld or monopod, 24-70	Lav until he goes to the bench, then camera audio
T-0:25	Bench, then stairs	The quiet moment on the bench, long hold. Then take the lav receiver off, swap to the 70-200, and go up to the gallery. Change card and battery on the stairs.	Monopod, 70-200	Camera audio
T-0:10	Gallery	Hold your spot. Wide of the arena filling. Vertical crowd shots on the phone.	Monopod, 70-200	Camera audio

Time	Where	What you capture	Setup	Sound
T-0:00	Gallery	Tip-off wide, then tight. Plays, reactions, bench, scoreboard, crowd. Follow him, not the ball.	Monopod, 70-200, 50 or 60 fps	Camera audio
Halftime	Gallery	Change card and battery. Ten clean crowd cut-aways. Scoreboard.	Same	Same
Final minute	Stairs	Come down. Swap to the 35 or 50 on the way. Be at courtside when the horn goes.	Handheld, 35 or 50	Lav ready in your pocket
Final buzzer	Court	Reactions, handshakes, the walk to the bench. Follow him.	Handheld	Camera audio
T+0:03	Court or bench	Beat 4: clip the lav on as you say hello, twenty seconds of nothing, then the three questions. Close, handheld, no lights.	Handheld, 35 or 50	Lav and camera
T+0:10	Court	He goes to the locker room. You stay for the empty-court shots on the tripod: wide, static, lights going down if they do. The bench. The exit doors.	Tripod, 24-70	Recorder, room tone, footsteps
T+0:40	Parking	Ahmad comes out. Walk-out through the doors into the night, wide and static, then the car. Mount the camera and the phone while he gets settled.	Window or dash mount, 35mm; phone	Lav on, recorder running

Time	Where	What you capture	Setup	Sound
T+0:50	The car	Beat 5: five minutes of normal talk, then roll and never stop. Drive the long way. Park somewhere quiet for the key questions with the engine off. Close with the ending line, two or three versions.	Same	Lav plus recorder
Wrap	Home	Back up every card to two drives before you sleep.		

Shot list by beat

Must shots are the ones the edit cannot live without. If the day goes wrong, protect them first.

Beat	Shot	Priority	Notes
0	Empty court, lights half down, static wide from court level	Must	After the game, on the tripod. Also the ending shot
0	Ahmad alone on the bench with the arena emptying behind	Nice	Only if he is willing to sit for a minute before the locker room
1	Long-lens approach from far away, outside	Must	Start rolling before he knows you see him
1	Gimbal walk-in, from behind then from the side	Must	Low and steady, 35mm
1	Details: shoes, bag strap, headphones on, keys	Must	Shoot on the move, never ask him to stop
1	Natural interaction at the entrance	Nice	Wide, let it happen
1	First look at the court, from behind his shoulder at the entrance	Must	The end of beat 1
1	The one question to camera on the walk	Must	Handheld, close, lav hidden

Beat	Shot	Priority	Notes
2	His named rituals on the court	Must	Know them in advance, be in position early
2	Stepping onto the court, low from the far baseline	Must	50 or 60 fps
2	Shooting routine, three angles one after another, same spot	Must	The centerpiece of pre-game, 50 or 60 fps, get the net sound
2	Stretching close-ups: hands, feet, breath	Nice	
2	Teammate handshakes, huddle, from the far side	Must	Long lens, never inside the circle
2	The quiet moment on the bench before tip-off, long hold	Must	Hold at least 15 seconds without moving. Last shot before you go up
2	Arena filling, wide from the gallery	Nice	On the phone or the body once you are up
3	Tip-off, the whole floor wide	Must	One shot, then tight
3	Four to six of his best plays, following him	Must	70-200 from the gallery, 50 or 60 fps
3	One defensive possession	Must	The high angle sells positioning
3	Reactions after plays, face and hands	Must	Stay on him two seconds after the play ends
3	Bench: towel, water, coach, scoreboard look	Must	Long lens from the gallery
3	Crowd cut-aways from inside the crowd: hands, faces, kids	Must	At least ten clean ones. Vertical on the phone too
3	Scoreboard and clock	Must	Several through the game
3	A timeout huddle from above	Nice	
4	Twenty seconds of silence on the court after the buzzer	Must	Roll before you speak
4	Three post-game answers at the bench	Must	Close, handheld, no lights
5	Conversation in the car, tight on his face from the window mount	Must	Eye line toward the road, not the lens

Beat	Shot	Priority	Notes
5	Conversation, second angle from the phone on the passenger side	Must	Wide enough to see the car and the lights outside
5	Night streets of Ramat Gan through the windshield and side window	Must	Before and after, ten clean shots
5	Ahmad doing something ordinary: driving, ordering, walking to the door	Nice	No talking
6	Two or three versions of the closing line, to the audience	Must	In the car, parked, engine off. Each shorter than the last
6	Walk-out through the arena doors into the night, wide and static	Must	The last frame of the film
6	Exit corridor, arena lights going down	Nice	Only if the court shots run long enough to catch it

The conversation setup

This is the most important forty minutes of the shoot. It is a minute and a half of the film on camera and the voice-over for everything else.

Location. The car ride home, first choice. Ahmad is not a big talker on camera, and a car solves that: he looks at the road, his hands are busy, nobody is staring at him, and the city lights do the production design. Second choice, a walk through his neighborhood at night. Third, his place on the couch. Whichever it is, it should be his choice and it should be the same night, while the game is still in him.

Cameras. One body on a window or dash mount on the passenger side, 35mm, framed tight on him with the side window behind. The phone on a small clamp lower on the dash or on the passenger seat, wide, showing the car and the lights outside. Both rolling the whole time, a clap at the start for sync. Check the mounts with the engine running before he gets in.

Light. Street lights and the dashboard are the look. Add the pocket LED only if his face is falling into shadow: dimmed, bounced off the ceiling or the sun visor, never pointed at him. Choose a route with lit streets.

Sound. Lav on Ahmad, receiver on the camera, the recorder running as backup in the cup holder. Windows up, air conditioning low, no radio. Record a full minute of room tone with the engine running and again with it off. The key questions and the ending line happen parked, engine off.

Running it.

1. Five minutes of normal talk before anything rolls. The game, food, anything. You are in the passenger seat or driving; decide beforehand and set the mounts for it.
2. Two asks of Ahmad: full sentences, and put the question in the answer.
3. Roll both the camera and the phone and never stop. No slating between questions.
4. Start with family and home. For a quiet talker that is the door; the hard questions come later, once he is going.
5. Follow the topic table in the Full script tab, beat 5. One question at a time, then "why" and "give me an example."
6. Let silence sit. Count to five before the next question. A quiet person's second sentence is the one you want.
7. Park somewhere quiet, engine off, for the last three topics and the ending line. Two or three versions, each shorter.
8. Keep rolling for two minutes after you say you are done. The best line often comes then.

Interviewer. That is you, beside him, never heard in the final film. Never talk over him and never react out loud mid-answer. Nod, wait. If he gives you one word, do not re-ask; say "tell me more about that" and wait again.

Vertical capture for the Reel

Shot natively in 9:16 on your phone. Grab these alongside the main coverage, never instead of it.

- [ ] Walk-in from behind, low, following him through the entrance
- [ ] Tight on his face on the bench before tip-off, three seconds minimum, for the hook
- [ ] Shoes and headphones detail on the move
- [ ] Shooting routine from directly behind the basket, slow motion
- [ ] Crowd from inside the gallery, phone held high, looking down at the floor
- [ ] Crowd reaction beside you after a big play
- [ ] Post-game walk to the bench
- [ ] The car: a vertical angle from the phone for the personality section
- [ ] Walk-out through the doors into the night

Game action itself is reframed from the 16:9 long-lens footage; a vertical camera cannot follow the play.

Post-production plan

Step	What happens	When
Backup	Every card copied to two drives. Nobody sleeps before this is done.	Shoot night
Transcript	The beat 4 and beat 5 recordings transcribed. Candidate voice-over lines marked by beat.	Day 1
Paper edit	The film laid out on paper: which line goes over which picture, the signature moment chosen.	Day 2
Assembly	Full timeline assembled, natural sound first, music placed, no color.	Day 3 to 5
Rough cut to Ahmad and client	Watermarked link. Notes in one round, within 48 hours.	Day 7
Picture lock	Notes applied, runtime final.	Day 9
Sound mix and color	Dialogue cleaned, music ducked under voice, color graded to the look rules.	Day 10 to 12
Reel and teaser	Cut from the locked film and the vertical captures. Captions added.	Day 11 to 13
Final delivery	Film in 4K 16:9, Reel and teaser in 9:16, 8 to 10 graded stills, thumbnail options.	Day 14
Release order	Teaser the day before. Film and Reel the same day, film first.	Agreed with Ahmad

Thumbnail. His face, mid-emotion, from the bench or the signature moment. His name, nothing else. Three options for him to pick from.

Risks and fallbacks

Risk	Fallback
Court access before the game is pulled on the night	Shoot warm-ups from the first row of the stands on the 70-200. Lose the low angles, keep the routine and the quiet moment.

Risk	Fallback
No fixed spot in the gallery	Arrive before the doors open and hold the first row at half court. If you lose it, the corner above a basket is the next best angle for drives and finishes.
Loss, or a quiet night for Ahmad	Follow the Win or lose table in the Full script tab. The conversation grows, the game shrinks.
Limited minutes or injury	Beat 3 becomes 45 seconds of bench, crowd and one moment of effort. Beat 5 carries the film.
Ahmad gives one-word answers	Do not push. Switch to home and family, drive, let the silence work. If the car is not working, stop, get food, and roll again at the table.
He goes straight to the locker room after the buzzer	Beat 4 happens on the walk from the floor to the exit, or the next day in the car as the first topic. The silence shot becomes the bench at warm-ups.
The car falls through	The walk home, or a bench outside the arena with the lights behind him. Same lav, same phone second angle.
One camera, and you miss a play	You will miss plays. That is why beat 3 is ninety seconds and needs four, not ten. Never chase; hold on him and let the plays come to the frame.
Bad arena light or flicker	Shutter at 1/50 or 1/60, test for flicker in warm-ups, manual white balance.
Audio lost on a key answer	Camera audio plus the recorder in the car; two sources at all times. Check the lav level before the first question, not after.
Running long on the day	Protect the Must shots in order: beat 5, beat 4, beat 3 signature moment, beat 1 walk-in. Everything else is nice to have.